

C202

Managing Human Capital

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A 300-person software firm in Austin raised all salaries 8% and renovated its break rooms. The next engagement survey showed far fewer complaints, but employees did not report feeling more motivated, and output stayed flat. Using Herzberg's two-factor theory, what explains the result?

- A.** Pay and working conditions are hygiene factors; they reduce dissatisfaction but do not create motivation.
- B.** Removing dissatisfaction should have raised motivation, so the survey must be flawed.
- C.** Hygiene factors never matter to employees.
- D.** Pay is a motivator, but its effect takes about a year to appear.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager wants to raise motivation, not just reduce complaints, according to Herzberg. Which change fits?

- A.** Raise pay, since money is the strongest motivator for everyone.
- B.** Improve the health insurance plan.
- C.** Give employees more responsibility and recognize their achievements.
- D.** Rewrite company policies to be clearer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A medical-device company offers a trip to Hawaii to every sales rep who books \$2 million in sales this year. The reps value the trip highly and trust that the company will deliver it, but most believe \$2 million is impossible in their territories. The program will cost about \$150,000. Using expectancy theory, which element is weak?

- A.** Instrumentality, the belief that performance will lead to the reward.
- B.** Expectancy, the belief that effort will lead to the required performance.
- C.** Valence, the value of the reward.
- D.** None; the high value of the trip makes up for the tough target.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An analyst earns \$70,000 and regularly works 45 hours a week. Her pay is above the local market median, and her company recently won a best-places-to-work award. She learns that a peer in the same role, with similar results, earns \$80,000 and works 40 hours. According to equity theory, what is most likely?

- A. She perceives underpayment and may cut effort, ask for a raise or look elsewhere.
- B. Nothing changes, because her pay is above the market median.
- C. She works harder, expecting that more effort will earn her the same pay.
- D. She feels overpaid and works harder to justify her salary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Under equity theory, which situation creates overpayment inequity?

- A. An employee learns she earns less than a peer with the same hours and results.
- B. Any time an employee's pay is above the market average.
- C. An employee earns fewer dollars than a peer who works proportionally more hours.
- D. An employee learns she earns more than a peer who puts in the same hours and produces the same results.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A supervisor gives an employee top ratings on every part of her review, including report writing, where her reports are often late and incomplete. The supervisor explains that she is outstanding with clients. The company switched to a new online review system this year. Which rating error is this?

- A. Central tendency error.
- B. Leniency error.
- C. Recency error.
- D. Halo effect.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A manager's annual ratings mostly reflect what each employee did in the last six weeks before the review. Which error is this?

- A.** Recency error.
- B.** Halo effect.
- C.** Primacy (first-impression) error.
- D.** Central tendency error.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A nursing department at a 250-bed hospital started the year with 180 nurses and ended with 220. During the year it hired 80 nurses and 40 nurses left. What was the annual turnover rate?

- A.** 40%
- B.** 60%
- C.** 22.2%
- D.** 20%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A customer-service training program cost \$40,000. At the end of class, 95% of attendees rated it excellent and passed a quiz. Three months later, team leads listen to calls and see agents using the new de-escalation steps with angry customers. Which Kirkpatrick level does the team leads' observation measure?

- A.** Level 2, learning.
- B.** Level 4, results.
- C.** Level 3, behavior.
- D.** Level 1, reaction, because 95% rated it excellent.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company wants to evaluate a training program at Kirkpatrick's Level 4. What should it measure?

- A.** Participants' satisfaction ratings at the end of class.
- B.** Changes in business outcomes, such as fewer complaints or lower turnover.
- C.** Scores on a post-training test.
- D.** Only return on investment in dollars.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A logistics company with offices in four states is hiring warehouse supervisors. The hiring manager, who has interviewed hundreds of candidates, wants the interview method that best predicts job performance and treats candidates consistently. Which method should she use?

- A.** Different questions for each candidate, based on each résumé.
- B.** Rely on her own judgment, since experienced interviewers are always accurate.
- C.** A structured interview that asks every candidate the same job-related behavioral questions and scores answers with a guide.
- D.** An unstructured conversation to judge cultural fit.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

Order pickers in a distribution center average 130 lines per hour. The manager, who was promoted from the floor two years ago, has always told the team to “do your best.” The building recently added new LED lighting. According to goal-setting theory, which change would most likely raise output?

- A.** Set the highest possible target, because harder goals always produce more effort.
- B.** Set a target of 145 lines per hour and post each shift's results daily.
- C.** Keep saying “do your best,” but more often.
- D.** Set a target of 120 lines per hour so everyone can succeed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

A ~~300-person~~ software firm in ~~Austin~~ raised all salaries 8% and renovated its break rooms. The next engagement survey showed far fewer complaints, but employees did not report feeling more motivated, and output stayed flat. Using Herzberg's two-factor theory, what explains the result?

Target word: why fewer complaints but no more motivation **Decides:** Pay and working conditions are hygiene factors.

A	Correct	Herzberg separates the factors that prevent dissatisfaction from the ones that motivate.
B	Inverted operation	Treats satisfaction and dissatisfaction as one scale; Herzberg says they are separate.
C	Absolute language	They matter a great deal; when they are poor, dissatisfaction rises.
D	Confusion set	Pay is classed as a hygiene factor, not a motivator.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A manager wants to raise motivation, not just reduce complaints, according to Herzberg. Which change fits?

Target word: a motivator **Decides:** Motivators come from the work itself.

A	Absolute language	Pay is a hygiene factor in Herzberg's model, and no single factor motivates everyone.
B	Confusion set	Benefits are a hygiene factor.
C	Correct	Responsibility and recognition are motivators.
D	Adjacent category	Policy and administration are hygiene factors.

3. Answer B Concept 2

A medical-device company offers a trip to Hawaii to every sales rep who books \$2 million in sales this year. The reps value the trip highly and trust that the company will deliver it, but most believe \$2 million is impossible in their territories. ~~The program will cost about \$150,000.~~ Using expectancy theory, which element is weak?

Target word: weak link in $V \times I \times E$ **Decides:** Reps doubt their effort can reach the target.

A	Confusion set	Reps trust the company to deliver the trip, so instrumentality is high.
B	Correct	Believing the quota is impossible means low effort-to-performance expectancy.
C	Adjacent category	The reps value the trip highly.
D	Inverted operation	The terms multiply, so one low term drags motivation down; they do not offset.

4. Answer A Concept 3

An analyst earns \$70,000 and regularly works 45 hours a week. ~~Her pay is above the local market median, and her company recently won a best places to work award.~~ She learns that a peer in the same role, with similar results, earns \$80,000 and works 40 hours. According to equity theory, what is most likely?

Target word: predicted reaction **Decides:** Her outcome-to-input ratio is lower than her peer's.

A	Correct	A lower ratio than the referent creates tension she acts to reduce.
B	Camouflage	Equity theory compares with a referent, not with a market average.
C	Confusion set	That reasoning belongs to expectancy theory, not equity theory.
D	Inverted operation	That is the reaction to overpayment; she is underpaid relative to her peer.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Under equity theory, which situation creates overpayment inequity?

Target word: overpayment case **Decides:** Own outcome-to-input ratio is higher than the referent's.

A	Inverted operation	That is underpayment inequity.
B	Absolute language	Equity is judged against a chosen referent, not a market figure.
C	Dropped element	Compares pay alone; the ratios may be equal.
D	Correct	Her ratio is higher than her referent's.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A supervisor gives an employee top ratings on every part of her review, including report writing, where her reports are often late and incomplete. The supervisor explains that she is outstanding with clients. ~~The company switched to a new online review system this year.~~ Which rating error is this?

Target word: rating error **Decides:** One strong trait inflates all other ratings.

A	Inverted operation	Central tendency pushes ratings to the middle, not the top.
B	Adjacent category	Leniency is a habit of rating everyone high, not one employee's traits spilling over.
C	Confusion set	Recency overweights recent events, not one trait.
D	Correct	Strength in one area spreads to every rating.

7. Answer A Concept 4 · transfer

A manager's annual ratings mostly reflect what each employee did in the last six weeks before the review. Which error is this?

Target word: rating error **Decides:** Recent events are overweighted.

A	Correct	Recent performance is given too much weight.
B	Confusion set	Halo spreads one trait across ratings; timing is not the cause.
C	Inverted operation	Primacy overweights the earliest information, the opposite end of the period.
D	Adjacent category	Central tendency rates everyone as average.

8. Answer D Concept 5

~~A nursing department at a 250-bed hospital~~ started the year with 180 nurses and ended with 220. During the year it hired 80 nurses and 40 nurses left. What was the annual turnover rate?

Target word: turnover rate **Decides:** Separations / average headcount; average = $(180 + 220) / 2 = 200$.

A	Confusion set	Uses the 80 hires instead of the 40 separations.
B	Adjacent category	Adds hires and separations together; only separations count.
C	Wrong stem number	Divides by the starting headcount of 180.
D	Correct	$40 / 200 = 20\%$.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A customer-service training program ~~cost \$40,000. At the end of class, 95% of attendees rated it excellent and passed a quiz.~~ Three months later, team leads listen to calls and see agents using the new de-escalation steps with angry customers. Which Kirkpatrick level does the team leads' observation measure?

Target word: level of the observation **Decides:** Skills are seen being used on the job.

A	Adjacent category	The quiz measured learning; watching real calls measures behavior.
B	Confusion set	Results would be business outcomes such as fewer complaints.
C	Correct	Transfer of learning to on-the-job behavior is level 3.
D	Camouflage	The ratings are level 1, but they are not what the question asks about.

10. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A company wants to evaluate a training program at Kirkpatrick's Level 4. What should it measure?

Target word: what level 4 measures **Decides:** Level 4 = organizational results.

A	Inverted operation	That is level 1, the opposite end of the model.
B	Correct	Level 4 looks at results for the organization.
C	Adjacent category	That is level 2, learning.
D	Absolute language	Level 4 covers many outcomes; dollar ROI is one possible measure.

11. Answer C Concept 7

A logistics company ~~with offices in four states~~ is hiring warehouse supervisors. The hiring manager, ~~who has interviewed hundreds of candidates,~~ wants the interview method that best predicts job performance and treats candidates consistently. Which method should she use?

Target word: most valid interview method **Decides:** Consistency and job-relatedness improve prediction.

A	Dropped element	Drops consistency, so candidates cannot be compared fairly.
B	Absolute language	Experience does not remove bias; structure does more.
C	Correct	Structure and job relevance give the highest validity and fairness.
D	Confusion set	Unstructured interviews are less reliable and more open to bias.

12. Answer B Concept 8

Order pickers in a distribution center average 130 lines per hour. The manager, ~~who was promoted from the floor two years ago,~~ has always told the team to "do your best." ~~The building recently added new LED lighting.~~ According to goal-setting theory, which change would most likely raise output?

Target word: goal that raises performance **Decides:** Specific, challenging, attainable goal plus feedback.

A	Absolute language	Goals seen as impossible lower commitment.
B	Correct	Specific and challenging but reachable, with feedback.
C	Dropped element	Still vague; specificity is what drives the effect.
D	Inverted operation	An easy goal lowers the bar instead of raising performance.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	9	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	2	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Herzberg's two-factor theory	Hygiene factors (pay, policies, working conditions) prevent dissatisfaction; motivators (achievement, recognition, responsibility, growth) create satisfaction and motivation.	Believing that removing dissatisfaction automatically creates motivation.	Better pay or conditions followed by “fewer complaints but no more effort.”
2	Expectancy theory	Motivation = expectancy × instrumentality × valence; if any one is near zero, motivation collapses.	Assuming a highly valued reward makes up for an unreachable target.	People want the reward but doubt they can hit the target, or doubt the reward will be paid.
3	Equity theory	People compare their outcome-to-input ratio with a referent's; an unequal ratio creates tension they act to reduce.	Comparing pay alone rather than pay relative to effort.	A worker learns what a peer earns and how hard the peer works.
4	Performance appraisal errors	Halo spreads one strong trait to all ratings; recency overweights recent events; central tendency rates everyone average; leniency rates everyone high.	Mixing up halo with leniency or recency.	What drives the distorted rating: one trait, recent events, or a rater's habit across all staff.
5	Turnover rate	Turnover rate = separations during the period / average headcount for the period.	Dividing by starting or ending headcount, or counting hires as separations.	Starting and ending headcount plus a number of people who left.
6	Kirkpatrick's four levels	Level 1 reaction, level 2 learning, level 3 behavior on the job, level 4 business results.	Treating high satisfaction scores as proof the training worked.	When and where the evidence is gathered: in class, on the job, or in business metrics.
7	Structured interviews	Structured interviews, with the same job-related questions and a scoring guide for every candidate, predict job performance better than unstructured conversations.	Trusting a free-flowing “fit” conversation or gut feel.	A question about the most valid or fair way to select candidates.
8	Goal-setting theory	Specific, challenging but attainable goals with feedback raise performance more than vague “do your best” goals.	Setting easy goals to build confidence, or impossible goals to push effort.	A vague goal and a question about how to raise output.

Course scope (public description): This course focuses on strategies and tools that managers use to maximize employee contribution and create organizational excellence. You will learn talent management strategies to motivate and develop employees as well as best practices to manage performance for added value.